

Muzhi Liu

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EDUCATION

Ph.D. in Political Science, Columbia University expected May 2028
Concurrent M.A. in Statistics, Columbia University expected May 2027
Selected coursework: Causal Inference, Field Experiment, Statistical Inference, Advanced Probability Theory, Bayesian Statistics, Machine Learning Theory & Application, Stochastic Processes, Game Theory, Optimization, Real Analysis, ODE & PDE. *Planned:* Fourier Analysis, Topology, Algebraic Curves.
B.A. in Political Science, *magna cum laude*, Emory University, Atlanta, GA May 2023

RESEARCH INTERESTS

Political Methodology; Political Behavior; Public Opinion; Political Economy

METHODS AND SKILLS

Causal inference; Experiments; Text-as-data/NLP; Machine Learning; LLM-assisted measurement; Mathematical modeling and analysis
Tools: R, Python, Stan, L^AT_EX, Git, SQL, Qualtrics, CloudResearch, Prolific

REVISE AND RESUBMIT

1. “Demobilization Without Backlash: Campaign Donations and the DOGE Workforce Reduction.” [*Revise and resubmit at **Political Behavior***]
2. “When Group Issues and Core Issues Collide: Evidence from Tailored Conjoint Experiments on Latino Voters” (with Yamil Velez). [*Revise and resubmit at **Political Behavior***]

MANUSCRIPTS UNDER REVIEW

1. “Borrowed Battlegrounds: When U.S. Political Violence Becomes Partisan News Abroad—Evidence from Five Language Communities on X (2024–2025).” [*Submitted*]
2. “Estimand-First Comparative Text Analysis: Measuring Discourse Change Across Co-Exposed Platforms.” [*Submitted*]
3. “Democracy Out of Sync: Circadian Misalignment and the Cost of Voting” (with Xuan Li). [*Submitted*]

ONGOING PROJECTS

1. “When Bad News Is Deniable: Holding Power and the Fragmentation of Partisan Economic Perceptions.” [*Draft in Progress*]
2. “Beyond the Ballot Box: Campaigns and the Politicization of Everyday Consumption.”
3. “Primary Election and Intra-Party Factions” (with Shigeo Hirano and Sam Frederick).

GRANTS AND AWARDS

IHS Mentorship Grant, Institute for Humane Studies (\$8,000) Summer 2026
American Political Science Association, Spring Centennial Research Grant Spring 2026 (\$2,500)
Columbia Experimental Laboratory for Social Sciences Student Seed Grant Fall 2025 (\$1,000)
First Place, Young Public Opinion Scholar Competition, NY/PA–NJ Summer 2025 AAPOR (\$1,000)

CONFERENCE
PRESENTATIONS

- American Political Science Association Annual Meeting (APSA)** Sep. 2026
Li, X.; **Liu, M.** “Democracy Out of Sync: Circadian Misalignment and the Cost of Voting.”
Liu, M. “When Partisan Anchors Make Parties Legible: Transnational Partisan Generalization After U.S. Political Violence.”
- Elections, Public Opinion, and Voting Behavior Conference** May 2026
Li, X.; **Liu, M.** “Democracy Out of Sync: Circadian Misalignment and the Cost of Voting.”
- Midwest Political Science Association Annual Conference (MPSA)** Apr. 2026
Liu, M. “Electoral Spectators: The 2024 U.S. Presidential Election and Online Political Discourse in China.”
- American Association for Public Opinion Research Annual Conference (AAPOR)** May 2025
Velez, Y.; **Liu, M.** “In Their Own Words: A Tailored Approach to Measuring Politicized Group Attachments.”

TEACHING
EXPERIENCE

- Teaching Assistant, Columbia University** 2024–2026
Graduate courses: Quantitative Methods IV: Advanced Statistical Modeling (Spring 2026); Quantitative Methods III: Field Experiments (Fall 2025); Math and Statistics in Political Science (Spring 2024).
Undergraduate courses: Introduction to American Politics and Government (Summer 2024; Spring 2025).

RESEARCH
EXPERIENCE

- Research Assistant, Columbia University** 2023–2024
Supervisors: Robert Shapiro and Alan Yang. Public opinion and polarization projects; cleaned and merged survey datasets; implemented regression and robustness pipelines in R; produced publication-ready figures and tables.
- Research Assistant, Emory University** 2021–2023
Supervisors: Kiela Crabtree, Zachary Peskowitz, and Kevin Sparrow. Research on political violence and minority politics; assembled datasets from public sources; conducted literature synthesis; supported survey/conjoint design and analysis; prepared replication-ready code and documentation.

ACADEMIC
SERVICE

- Editorial Assistant, *Political Science Quarterly* Mar. 2024–Spring 2026
Linkage Chair, Political Science Graduate Student Council, Columbia University Jun. 2024–May 2025
Member, Student Advisory Board, Emory University Sep. 2021–May 2023

PROFESSIONAL
EXPERIENCE

- Community Engagement Intern, International Rescue Committee, Atlanta, GA Jun. 2023–Sep. 2023
Academic Consultant and Instructor, Yuan Foundation, Washington, DC May 2023–Aug. 2023
Research Assistant, Ashoka, Remote Jan. 2023–Apr. 2023